GLOUCESTER
ZAKAT FUND
CHARITY FOR LOCAL RESIDENTS

TRUSTEES' CODE OF CONDUCT

Document Information	
Policy Name	Trustees' Code of Conduct
Version	1.0
Policy Owner	Board of Trustees
Approved by	Board of Trustees
Date Approved	01/02/2026
Next Review Date	01/02/2028
Related Policies	Conflict of Interest Policy, Expenses Policy, Equality Diversity and Inclusion Policy, Safeguarding Policy, Data Protection Policy

1. Introduction

Gloucester Zakat Charity ("the Charity") is a Charitable Incorporated Organisation established to prevent and relieve poverty and financial hardship in Gloucestershire and the wider United Kingdom, with a particular focus on members of the Muslim community. The Charity collects and distributes Zakat (obligatory Islamic almsgiving) and Sadaqah (voluntary charity) to eligible beneficiaries.

The Board of Trustees is collectively responsible for the governance and strategic direction of the Charity. Trustees hold a position of trust and are accountable to the Charity Commission, donors, beneficiaries, and the wider community for the proper stewardship of the Charity's resources and reputation.

This Code of Conduct sets out the standards of behaviour expected of all trustees and the principles that should guide their conduct in fulfilling their duties.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this Code of Conduct is to:

- Set out the standards of behaviour expected of trustees
- Ensure trustees understand their responsibilities
- Protect the Charity's reputation and integrity
- Promote public confidence in the Charity
- Provide a framework for addressing breaches of expected standards
- Complement the Charity Commission's guidance on the duties and responsibilities of charity trustees

3. Scope

This Code of Conduct applies to all trustees of the Charity. By accepting appointment as a trustee, each individual agrees to abide by this Code.

4. General Conduct

Trustees are required to:

- Act with honesty and integrity at all times
- Exercise good judgement in all matters relating to the Charity
- Act in the best interests of the Charity at all times, putting the Charity's interests before personal interests
- Seek professional advice on appropriate matters where trustees do not have relevant expertise
- Conduct themselves in a manner that upholds and does not damage or undermine the reputation of the Charity
- Treat fellow trustees, volunteers, beneficiaries, partners, and members of the public with respect and courtesy

5. Independence and Integrity

Trustees must act independently and with integrity. Specifically, trustees:

- Must act independently, particularly in relation to the Charity's assets, property, and legal and regulatory obligations
- Must not place themselves under any financial or other obligation to outside individuals or organisations that might seek to influence them in the performance of their duties
- Must avoid actual impropriety and any appearance of improper behaviour
- Must not act in order to gain financial or other benefits for themselves or for any persons connected to them, such as family members, friends, or any organisation that they own, manage, or work for
- Should avoid accepting gifts and hospitality that might reasonably be thought to influence them in carrying out their role as trustee

5.1 Gifts and Hospitality

Any gifts or hospitality received in connection with the Charity should not exceed the value of £50 and must be declared to the Board. Trustees should exercise caution and good judgement when accepting any gift or hospitality, considering whether acceptance could create any perception of impropriety or obligation.

6. Trustee Role and Commitment

Trustees should:

- Understand their roles and responsibilities and perform them to the best of their abilities
- Provide adequate time and commitment to fulfil the role of trustee
- Prepare adequately for Board meetings by reading papers and other materials in advance
- Participate actively in Board discussions and decision-making
- Be willing to take on specific responsibilities as agreed with the Board
- Keep up to date with relevant developments and best practice in charity governance

7. Board Meetings

In relation to Board meetings, trustees should:

- Aim to attend all meetings, giving apologies in advance if unable to attend
- Contribute appropriately and effectively to discussions, without dominating or preventing others from contributing
- Respect the authority of the Chair and the Chair of any meeting
- Bring a fair and open-minded view to all discussions
- Maintain a respectful balance between speaking and listening
- Treat different views with respect, even when disagreeing
- Ensure that all decisions are made in the best interests of the Charity
- Bring a genuinely independent perspective to enhance decision-making
- Accept collective responsibility for Board decisions, supporting decisions made by the Board even where the trustee personally disagreed

8. Working with Volunteers

The Charity is volunteer-run and does not employ staff. In working with volunteers, trustees should:

- Support volunteers in carrying out their duties
- Serve as an example of how everyone in the Charity should conduct themselves, reflecting the values of the Charity
- Work considerately and fairly with everyone in a way that respects diversity, different roles, and boundaries
- Avoid giving offence and treat all volunteers with dignity and respect
- Accept and respect the difference between the governance role of the Board and the operational role of volunteers
- Foster a supportive and collaborative environment

9. Legal Requirements and Compliance

Trustees must:

- Act in accordance with the Charity's governing document (Constitution)
- Ensure that the Charity complies with all applicable laws, including charity law, data protection law, health and safety law, and any other relevant legislation
- Comply with the Charity's Conflict of Interest Policy and ensure the conflict of interest register is completed and updated as required
- Abide by all policies approved by the Board, including but not limited to: Equality, Diversity and Inclusion Policy; Safeguarding Policy; Data Protection Policy; Anti-Money Laundering Policy; and Counter Extremism Policy
- Report any serious incidents to the Charity Commission in accordance with the Commission's guidance

10. Confidentiality

Trustees must:

- Maintain confidentiality about sensitive Board matters and any information received in confidence
- Not disclose confidential information about beneficiaries, donors, or the Charity's operations to third parties without proper authorisation
- Be aware that the duty of confidentiality does not prevent disclosure to the Charity Commission or other statutory body where necessary to comply with legal obligations or to report matters that could threaten the Charity or represent a breach of law

11. Expenses

Trustees may claim reasonable expenses incurred in the course of their duties in accordance with the Charity's Expenses Policy. This includes:

- Travel expenses
- Subsistence costs where appropriate
- Other necessary costs directly related to trustee duties

Claims must be submitted with valid receipts using the approved process and approved by the Chair (or another trustee for the Chair's own expenses). The Expenses Policy should be read alongside this Code of Conduct.

12. Breaches of this Code

All trustees are expected to uphold this Code of Conduct. Where a trustee is found to be in breach of the standards set out in this Code:

- The trustee will be asked to meet with the Chair to discuss the matter and assess their suitability for the role
- If the breach involves the Chair, the trustee will meet with another trustee nominated by the Board
- The outcome of the meeting will be reported to the Board
- Consistent or serious breaches of this Code may result in the trustee being asked to resign or their tenure being terminated in accordance with the Charity's Constitution

13. Review

This Code of Conduct will be reviewed by the Board of Trustees every two years, or sooner if there are significant changes to relevant legislation or Charity Commission guidance.

14. Related Guidance

Charity Commission Guidance:

- The Essential Trustee: What you need to know, what you need to do (CC3)
- Charity trustee: what's involved
- Conflicts of interest: a guide for charity trustees (CC29)
- It's your decision: charity trustees and decision making
- Charity Governance Code

15. Approval and Version History

Version	Date	Approved By	Changes
1.0	01/02/2026	Board of Trustees	Initial policy

16. Trustee Acknowledgement and Declaration

I confirm that I have read, understood, and agree to abide by this Trustees' Code of Conduct. I understand that failure to comply with this Code may result in action being taken in accordance with Section 12 above.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Mr Abdullah Abdul Samad Patel	Chair	A. Patel	01/02/2026
Mr Kamel Boulkenafet	Trustee	K. Boulkenafet	01/02/2026
Mr Hashim Moolla	Trustee	H. Moolla	01/02/2026
Mr Farouq Ginwalla	Trustee	F. Ginwalla	01/02/2026
Ms Mariam Qureshi	Trustee	M. Qureshi	01/02/2026

--- End of Code of Conduct ---